

Decide: length, place and dates

Choosing Your Retreat Length and Location

If you can, choose a format and a target month. If you cannot decide yet, write down what you still need to arrange, and come back later.

1. Length

- ☐ **Three days** (recommended for this course; not a spiritual requirement). Which three?
- ☐ **One day** (about eight to ten hours, with meals, walks and rest)
- ☐ **Three hours** (an immediate pause, not the full retreat, not crisis care)
- ☐ **At home** (Sessions 1, 2, 3, 4, a rest day, then 5, 7 and 10, over eight days)

2. Place, and whom you need to ask (and when)

Place	Main advantage	Main challenge	Best suited for
Home alone	Free and familiar	Chores and digital distraction	One-day or three-day retreat
Home with others	Accessible	Frequent interruption	At-home format
Borrowed home	Affordable and separate	Privacy and access arrangements	One-day or three-day retreat
Church building	Quiet and inexpensive	Security and interruptions	Day retreat
Retreat centre	Purpose-built environment	Cost and travel	First three-day retreat
Hotel or guesthouse	Privacy and availability	Phone, television and expense	One-day or three-day retreat
Outdoors	Natural quiet and movement	Weather and safety	Individual sessions, not usually the whole retreat

The book's table of places (Chapter 6)

3. The seven questions for your place

Tick each one you can answer “yes”. Any “no” needs a solution or a different place.

- ☐ 1. Can I have protected time here?
- ☐ 2. Does this place help me feel sufficiently safe and settled?
- ☐ 3. Can I sleep well here?
- ☐ 4. Can I eat simply here?
- ☐ 5. Can I control my connectivity without losing access to help?
- ☐ 6. Can this place support my physical needs?
- ☐ 7. Can I afford it without stress?

Solutions for any “no”:

4. Dates

The retreat itself, plus a softer day before and after if you can arrange it. Or, at least, a target month.

My Retreat Plan (optional)

A format, and a guide if one applies. You can change it at any time.

- ☐ Three-day
- ☐ One-day
- ☐ Three-hour
- ☐ At-home

With a guide:

- ☐ Couples (not for repairing a marriage under strain, and not where there is fear or abuse)
- ☐ Small group or church
- ☐ Pastors and Christian leaders